23-27117 ROBEN F. NILLO
BCS323L-OCa Information Assurance & Security
2nd Sem SY 2025-26
10:00am-1:00pm Wed
Activity #6 Security Policies and Procedures
March 11, 2026

Task 1: Drafting an Acceptable Use Policy:

VERTEX INNOVATIONS
Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)
Version 1.0 | Effective Date: March 2026

Scope: This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and interns of Vertex Innovations who use company-owned devices, systems, networks, or communication tools.

1. Personal Use of Company Technology

- Employees must use company devices and internet access primarily for work-related tasks during business hours (9:00 AM – 6:00 PM).
- Limited personal use is permitted, but only outside core hours, before 9:00 AM, during the lunch break (12:00 PM – 1:00 PM), or after 6:00 PM. Personal use must not affect work performance or slow down company systems. Employees must not access illegal or inappropriate content on company devices at any time. Streaming services, online gaming, and large personal downloads are not permitted on company networks.
- Vertex Innovations will monitor internet activity on company devices. Employees have no expectation of privacy when using company technology.

2. Social Media and Online Representation

- Employees must not post confidential company information, client data, or internal project details on any personal or public social media account. Employees must not claim to represent Vertex Innovations on personal accounts without written approval from the Marketing or HR department. Any personal post about company-related topics must include a clear disclaimer, such as: "Views are my own and do not represent Vertex Innovations."
- Employees must not post content that is harmful, discriminatory, or damaging to the company's reputation. Official company communications will only come from approved accounts managed by the Marketing team. Employees found misrepresenting the company online will be subject to disciplinary action.

3. Hardware Care and Responsibility

- Employees must handle all assigned company equipment with care and keep it in good working condition. Devices must be locked when not in use and must not be left unattended in public places.
- If a device is lost or stolen, the employee must report it to the IT Department within 2 hours. If a device is damaged due to negligence or misuse, the employee will be required to cover repair or replacement costs. Accidental damage must still be reported to the IT Department within 24 hours, failure to report may result in the employee bearing full replacement costs. Employees must not attempt to repair or modify company hardware themselves. All repairs must go through the IT Department.
- Company equipment remains the property of Vertex Innovations and must be returned in good condition upon end of employment.

4. Reporting Suspicious Activity

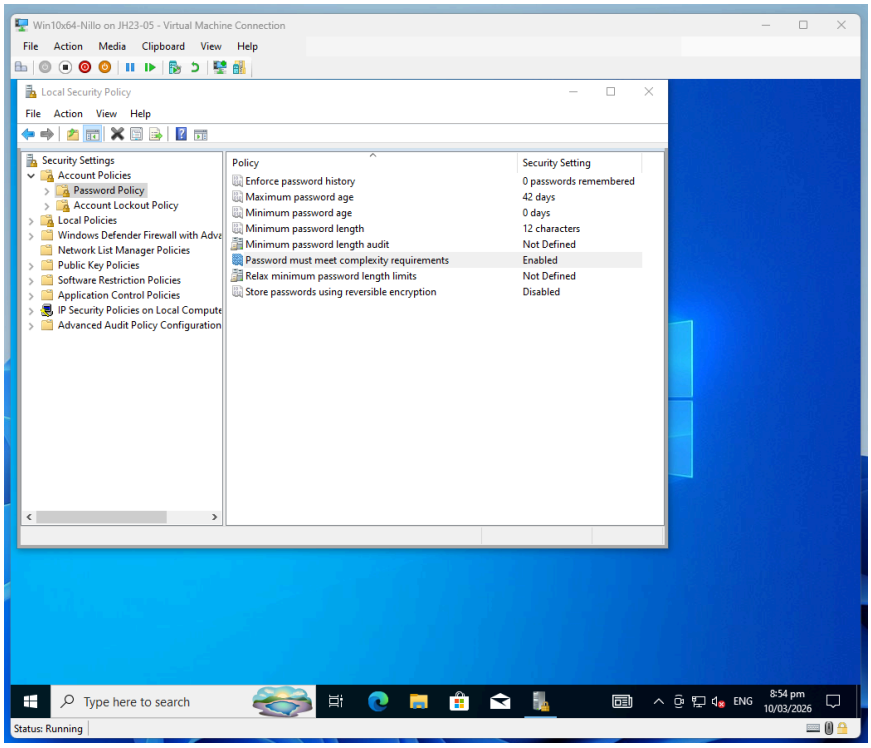
- Employees must report any suspicious emails, unusual system behaviour, or potential security threats immediately. Reports must be sent to the IT Security Team at security@vertexinnovations.com (available 24/7). For device-related issues, employees must contact the IT Helpdesk at it-help@vertexinnovations.com or Ext. 200. HR can also be contacted at hr@vertexinnovations.com or Ext. 101 for anonymous reports.
- Employees must not ignore, delete, or attempt to handle security threats on their own. All security matters will be investigated by the IT Security Team.

Policy Acknowledgement
All employees must read and sign this policy within 5 business days of their start date. Signed copies must be submitted to HR. Violation of this policy will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

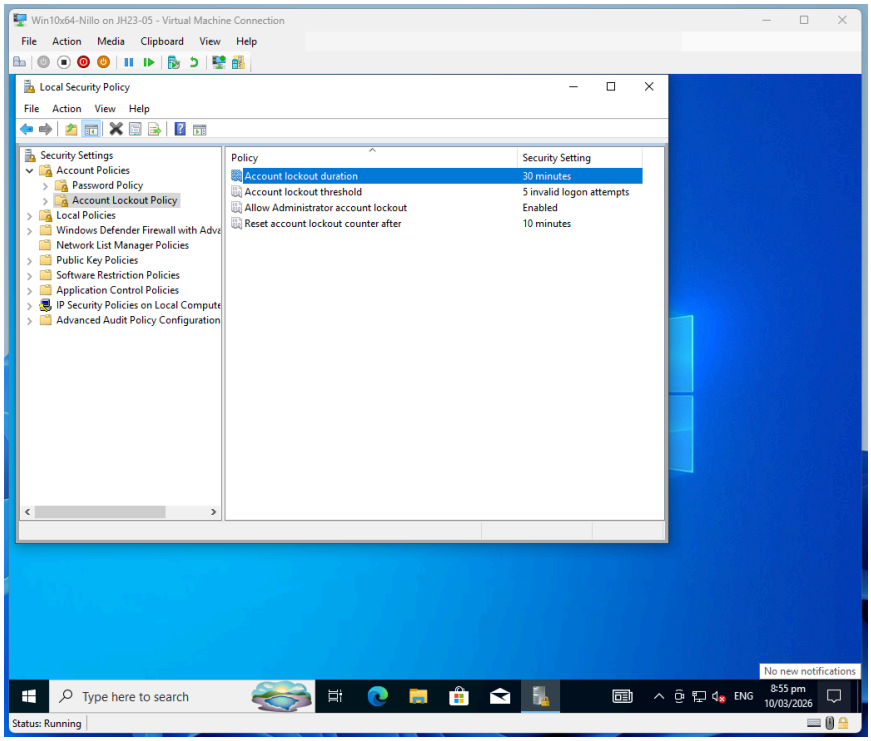
Employee Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Task 2: Translating Policy to Procedure:

Configure Account Policies:



Configure Account Lockout (Defense against Brute Force):



Task 3: Standard Operating Procedure:

VERTEX INNOVATIONS
Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) — Employee Offboarding
IT Department | Version 1.0 | Effective Date: March 2026

Purpose: This SOP tells the IT Department exactly what steps to follow when an employee leaves Vertex Innovations, to make sure no data is lost or stolen.
Who follows this SOP: IT staff, with support from HR and the employee's direct manager.
When to start: On the same day HR confirms an employee's resignation or termination.

PHASE 1 — PHYSICAL ASSETS
Goal: Collect all company equipment from the employee.

- [ ] Step 1.1 — HR must notify the IT Department on the employee's last working day, or earlier if possible.
- [ ] Step 1.2 — IT staff must collect the following items from the employee before they leave the building:
  - Company laptop or desktop computer
  - Mobile phone (if company-issued)
  - Security badge and access key card
  - USB drives, external hard drives, or any storage devices
  - Headset, monitor, or any other peripherals
- [ ] Step 1.3 — IT staff must check each item and record its condition on the Equipment Return Form.
- [ ] Step 1.4 — If any item is missing, IT must report this to HR and the employee's manager immediately.
- [ ] Step 1.5 — All collected devices must be stored in the IT secure room until they are wiped and reassigned.

PHASE 2 — DIGITAL ACCESS
Goal: Remove all the employee's access to company systems.

- [ ] Step 2.1 — Disable the employee's Active Directory (AD) account on or before their last day at 5:00 PM.
- [ ] Step 2.2 — Disable and archive the employee's company email account. Do not delete it — it must be kept for 90 days for review.
- [ ] Step 2.3 — Revoke access to all business systems and tools, including:
  - Microsoft 365 / Google Workspace
  - Slack, Teams, or other communication tools
  - Project management tools (e.g., Jira, Trello, Asana)
  - CRM, ERP, or any financial systems
  - VPN and remote desktop access
  - Cloud storage (e.g., OneDrive, Google Drive, Dropbox)
- [ ] Step 2.4 — Change any shared team passwords or accounts that the employee had access to.
- [ ] Step 2.5 — Invalidate all multi-factor authentication (MFA) tokens linked to the employee's account.
- [ ] Step 2.6 — Remove the employee from all distribution lists, shared inboxes, and mailing groups.
- [ ] Step 2.7 — Set up an automatic email reply on their account informing senders of a new point of contact.

PHASE 3 — KNOWLEDGE TRANSFER
Goal: Make sure important information stays inside the company.

- [ ] Step 3.1 — At least 3 business days before the employee's last day, IT must work with the employee's manager to identify what needs to be handed over.
- [ ] Step 3.2 — The employee must transfer all project files to the shared company drive or a folder assigned by their manager.
- [ ] Step 3.3 — The employee must hand over any passwords for tools or accounts they managed. These must be submitted through the company's password manager — not sent by email or chat.
- [ ] Step 3.4 — IT must verify that all handover files are accessible to the relevant team members before the employee's last day.
- [ ] Step 3.5 — IT must check that no critical files are stored only on the employee's local device. If found, these must be copied to the company server immediately.
- [ ] Step 3.6 — The employee's manager must sign off on the Knowledge Transfer Checklist to confirm everything has been received.

PHASE 4 — AUDIT
Goal: Check for any unusual activity or data theft before or during offboarding.

- [ ] Step 4.1 — IT must check the employee's file download and access history for the last 30 days, looking for large or unusual downloads.
- [ ] Step 4.2 — IT must check if any files were sent to personal email addresses or uploaded to personal cloud accounts.
- [ ] Step 4.3 — IT must review login activity logs for any access outside of normal working hours.
- [ ] Step 4.4 — IT must scan all returned physical devices before wiping them, to confirm no company data was left on external drives.
- [ ] Step 4.5 — If any suspicious activity is found, IT must inform the IT Security Team and HR immediately. The issue must be documented and escalated before the device is wiped.
- [ ] Step 4.6 — Once the audit is complete and no issues are found, IT may proceed to wipe and reimage the returned devices.
- [ ] Step 4.7 — IT must complete the Offboarding Completion Report and send a copy to HR within 5 business days of the employee's last day.

COMPLETION SIGN-OFF
TaskCompleted ByDatePhysical Assets CollectedDigital Access RemovedKnowledge Transfer ConfirmedAudit Completed
IT staff member: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____
HR representative: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Task 4: Compliance Spot Check:
VERTEX INNOVATIONS — Policy & Procedure Violation Analysis

WHICH SOP STEPS FAILED?
Multiple steps in the Offboarding SOP were not followed correctly:

- Phase 1 — Physical Assets:
  Step 1.2 and Step 1.3 were violated. IT staff did not collect Alice's laptop before she left the building. The laptop was left unsecured on her desk, which means no one checked its condition or confirmed the return. This is a serious risk because anyone could access the device.
- Phase 2 — Digital Access:
  Step 2.3 and Step 2.5 were violated. Alice's VPN access was not revoked on her last day, which allowed her to connect to the company network from home. Her MFA token was also not invalidated. If both steps had been completed on time, Alice would not have been able to log in at all.
- Phase 4 — Audit:
  Step 4.2 was violated. IT did not monitor whether files were being downloaded or sent outside the network. Alice was able to download a file after leaving, and this went undetected.

WHICH AUP SECTION WAS VIOLATED?

- Section 1 — Personal Use was violated. The AUP states that Vertex Innovations monitors internet activity on company devices and systems. Alice used company access after her employment ended, which is no longer authorized use.
- Section 4 — Reporting was also relevant here. If any colleague or system noticed the unusual after-hours login, it should have been reported to the IT Security Team immediately under the reporting procedure.

HOW WOULD TECHNICAL CONTROLS HAVE HELPED?
If the technical security settings from Task 2 were in place, the following controls would have stopped her:

- Account Lockout Policy — After a set number of wrong password attempts (typically 3 to 5), the system would automatically lock the account. Alice would not be able to keep guessing without triggering a lockout.
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) — Even if Alice somehow guessed the correct password, she would still need a second form of verification — such as a code sent to the manager's phone. Without the manager's physical device, she could not complete the login.
- VPN Access Control — If Alice's own VPN credentials had been revoked as required in Step 2.3, she would not even have been able to reach the internal network in the first place. The attack would have stopped before it started.
- Audit Logs and Alerts — If login monitoring was active, an alert would have been triggered by the failed password attempts or by an unusual login from Alice's home IP address outside of working hours. The IT Security Team would have been notified automatically.